

Finance Committee Meeting September 24, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DfY9YO3PVLA
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Municipal Meeting Report: Finance Committee of the Muncie Common Council

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The transcript begins directly with the regular proceedings of the Finance Committee work session; no separate statutory public hearing or committee session was held immediately prior to calling the meeting to order.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Chairman Dale Basham called the second meeting of the Finance Committee of the Muncie Common Council to order **00:00:17**.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Dale Basham (Chairman), William Macintosh, and Jerry Dishman.
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Dale Basham, Chairman.
 - **Other Officials/Staff Present:** Lacy Jones (City Clerk's Office), Amber Green (Director of Communications), Caleb Robbins (Assistant Director of Communications), Brandon Murphy (City Council Attorney), and Matt Waggle (City Controller).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance led by Chairman Basham 00:00:22.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** *Not addressed in this transcript segment.*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

(The committee conducted budget review hearings and interviews with various municipal department heads concerning their proposed budgets.)

Item A: 00:03:03 Muncie City Court Budget Review

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Judge Amanda Dunnick, Muncie City Court.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Judge Dunnick presented the proposed city court budget, noting that standalone criminal misdemeanors, ordinance violations, and infractions (such as traffic tickets) for Muncie and Delaware County are handled by the court. Staffing consists of four secretaries (requested correction from two to three in the baseline submission), a bailiff, a probation officer, and a public defender. Salaries reflect a standard 5% increase following controller instructions, except for the probation officer whose salary is calculated via statutory minimums. Discussion also covered software maintenance (LEAP/BIS Digital), the "judge pro tem" line item, copier/psychological evaluation expenses, and Spanish language interpreter contracts with Andrea Johnson (\$60/day).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None (Public comments were restricted during this budget review phase).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational budget review only; no formal vote recorded.

Item B: 00:14:53 City Clerk's Office Budget Review

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Belinda (City Clerk).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Clerk Belinda reviewed the clerk's office budget, noting that staff raises follow the standard 5% model while her own elected official salary request was calculated closer to 8-10% to account for increased duties (board works, ethics commission assistance, court support) and historical under-compensation compared to department heads. She also highlighted \$35,000 in city insurance savings due to staff opting out of coverage and requested adjustments for travel and training. Committee members discussed equipment maintenance lines and Askme union guidelines.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational budget review only; no formal vote recorded.

Item C: 00:27:34 Muncie Police Department Budget Review

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Sloan, Deputy Chief Chris Degan, and Deputy Chief Melissa Crosswell.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Chief Sloan and his team presented the police department budget. The department operates with an authorized strength of 109 (currently staffed at 104) and handles approximately 50,000 calls annually. Discussion focused on salary and benefit increases, stabilizing retention rates, the university internship pipeline, overtime pressures, and the expansion of the police social worker program from one to two full-time positions. Additionally, the department addressed software subscriptions (Lexipol policy and training management), fleet maintenance repair costs, and body-worn camera contracts (Axon).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational budget review only; no formal vote recorded.

Item D: 01:03:26 Parks Department Budget Review

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone, Park Superintendent.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Superintendent Carl Malone reported on the management of 32 parks, noting that staff raises are set at 5%. Despite being down 5 to 6 staff members daily and hiring zero seasonal help, the department completed major capital improvements, including new concrete restrooms at Thomas Park and Riverview Community Center, and basketball court repairs at McCullha Park. Discussion touched upon the urban forester position, storm/flood recovery work from recent severe weather, deferred skate park lighting, and operations surrounding Tuohy Pool and Prairie Creek.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational budget review only; no formal vote recorded.

Item E: 01:20:47 Human Rights Commission Budget Review

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Michelle Clark, President of the Human Rights Commission.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Michelle Clark presented corrected budget adjustments, noting that payroll expenses reflect the standard 5% increase while non-payroll expenses were reallocated (reducing office supplies and training travel to establish new line items for computers/printers, event sponsorships, and \$960 for live-streaming services with Caleb Robbins). Attorney fees were reduced to zero due to reliance on pro bono services. Controller Matt Waggle advised on how line item transfers and new line creation must be handled via journal entries or council resolutions depending on series matching. Clark also provided an update on the active hiring process for a new executive director.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational budget review only; no formal vote recorded.

Item F: 01:33:28 Public Access & Communications Budget Review

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Amber Green, Director of Communications.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Director Green stated that her department's budget covers salary and benefits with a 5% increase and has been funded out of the general fund since 2025. Committee members and Green discussed ongoing technical challenges, Comcast cable provider agreements regarding Government/Public Access Channel 60, and legacy transmission infrastructure.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational budget review only; no formal vote recorded.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No general public comment period or citizen forum was held during this committee work session, as presiding officers explicitly noted public comments would be heard when the budget is formally considered for action by the common council.*
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Chairman Basham announced that the committee will reconvene for its third and final budget session on Wednesday, September 30th 01:05:58.
 - **Adjournment:** A motion to adjourn was made and seconded, approved by voice vote (All those in favor: Aye), officially adjourning the meeting 01:41:04.
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